

SECTION TWENTY

QUICK REFERENCE SHEETS

These sheets are designed for easy access while writing. Fill them in as you complete other sections, then keep them accessible during drafting.

How to Use This Section

When to fill this in:

- After completing each section of the workbook, transfer key answers here
- Before starting to draft, review and complete any gaps
- During drafting, update with new details you establish

How to use while writing:

- Keep these sheets open (printed or in a separate window)
- Check before writing any scene: Are my details consistent?
- Add new details in “Things I’ve Established Mid-Draft” as you create them

The goal: Never pause mid-scene wondering “how does this work?” or “did I establish this?” The answers are here.

WORLD AT-A-GLANCE

GENRE/SUBGENRE

SETTING IN ONE SENTENCE

YOUR ANSWER

TECH/MAGIC LEVEL

Continue in Section 9

Technology; Section 10 — Magic

TONE/ATMOSPHERE

Romance tone: (intense, tender, angsty, playful, slow-burn)

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Complement

☐

Intentional contrast

Key Locations (3-5)

Continue in Section 15

Key Locations

Dangerous Regions:

Continue in Section 1

Geography

YOUR ANSWER

Travel Times:

FROM	TO	TIME

Who Rules

Continue in Section 5

Government, Power & Law

GOVERNMENT TYPE

CURRENT RULER(S)

MAJOR FACTIONS/HOUSES

YOUR ANSWER

WHO HAS REAL POWER

CHARACTER QUICK REFERENCE

Protagonist

NAME

Also called: (nicknames, titles, aliases) _____

AGE

Physical appearance: (key details for consistency)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTINGUISHING FEATURES

What they wear typically:

Continue in Section 3

Dress, Appearance & Adornment

YOUR ANSWER

VOICE/SPEECH PATTERNS

KEY PERSONALITY TRAITS

YOUR ANSWER

GREATEST STRENGTH

GREATEST FLAW

WHAT THEY WANT (EXTERNAL GOAL)

WHAT THEY NEED (INTERNAL)

EMOTIONAL WOUND/FEAR

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

Love Interest

NAME

Also called: (nicknames, titles, aliases) _____

AGE

Physical appearance: (key details for consistency)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTINGUISHING FEATURES

WHAT THEY WEAR TYPICALLY

VOICE/SPEECH PATTERNS

KEY PERSONALITY TRAITS

YOUR ANSWER

GREATEST STRENGTH

GREATEST FLAW

WHAT THEY WANT (EXTERNAL GOAL)

WHAT THEY NEED (INTERNAL)

EMOTIONAL WOUND/FEAR

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

Key Supporting Characters

Character 1:

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

Character 2:

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

Character 3:

NAME

ROLE IN STORY

RELATIONSHIP TO PROTAGONIST

KEY TRAIT

Antagonist:

NAME

WHAT THEY WANT

WHY THEY OPPOSE THE PROTAGONISTS

YOUR ANSWER

What system they represent:

Continue in Section 16

Antagonist & Systems

YOUR ANSWER

TIMELINE

Story Timeline

HOW MUCH TIME PASSES IN THE STORY

STARTING DATE/SEASON

ENDING DATE/SEASON

Key Dates/Events

Before story begins:

Continue in Section 7

History

YOUR ANSWER

Act 1:

ACT 1:

Act 2:

ACT 2:

Act 3:

ACT 3:

Time Between Key Events

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

FROM [EVENT] TO [EVENT]

Important Historical Dates

Continue in Section 7

History & Lore

YOUR ANSWER

GLOSSARY

Made-Up Terms

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

TERM

MEANING

Place Names (with pronunciation if needed)

YOUR ANSWER

Character Names (spelling reference)

YOUR ANSWER

Titles and Forms of Address

Continue in Section 3

Language of Deference; Section 8 — Titles & Terms

YOUR ANSWER

THE MAGIC SYSTEM

Continue in Section 10

Magic System

Core Rules

WHO CAN USE MAGIC

HOW MAGIC IS ACCESSED

WHAT MAGIC COSTS

What magic CANNOT do:

Magic & Romance

Continue in Section 11

Magic & Intimacy

HOW MAGIC PUSHES THEM TOGETHER

YOUR ANSWER

HOW MAGIC PULLS THEM APART

YOUR ANSWER

THE INTIMACY MECHANIC

(How does magic create vulnerability or connection?)

YOUR ANSWER

MAGICAL CONSEQUENCE OF THEIR UNION

YOUR ANSWER

Bond Mechanics (if applicable)

Continue in Section 11

Magic & Intimacy; Section 18 — Agency Check

Bond type: (fated mates, soul bond, telepathic link, magical contract, other)

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

One didn't

☐

Yes, freely

☐

At moderate cost

☐

At great cost

☐

No

WHAT THE BOND DOES

YOUR ANSWER

What the bond doesn't do: (it doesn't replace genuine emotional connection)

YOUR ANSWER

Creature Bonds

Continue in Section 2

Flora, Fauna & Ecosystems

BONDED CREATURE/MOUNT (PROTAGONIST)

BONDED CREATURE/MOUNT (LOVE INTEREST)

HOW CREATURE BONDS AFFECT THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

SENSORY PALETTE

Keep these details consistent throughout your writing.

Continue in Section 1

Geography; Section 2 — Flora & Fauna

Visual

DOMINANT COLORS OF THE WORLD

Quality of light: (golden, grey, harsh, soft, magical glow)

YOUR ANSWER

WHAT THE SKY LOOKS LIKE

VISUAL MOTIFS THAT REPEAT

Sound

AMBIENT SOUNDS OF PRIMARY SETTING

YOUR ANSWER

SOUNDS ASSOCIATED WITH MAGIC

SOUNDS OF DANGER/TENSION

Smell

WHAT THE PRIMARY SETTING SMELLS LIKE

YOUR ANSWER

SCENT ASSOCIATED WITH PROTAGONIST

SCENT ASSOCIATED WITH LOVE INTEREST

Touch/Temperature

CLIMATE FEEL

TEXTURES THAT MATTER

WHAT MAGIC FEELS LIKE

Taste

Common foods/drinks:

Continue in Section 2

What They Eat

YOUR ANSWER

LUXURY FOODS

WHAT THEY EAT TOGETHER

SOCIETY & CULTURE

Continue in Section 3

Culture, Customs & Daily Life

Social Hierarchy

TOP

MIDDLE

BOTTOM

PROTAGONIST'S PLACE

LOVE INTEREST'S PLACE

Values & Taboos

WHAT THIS CULTURE VALUES MOST

WHAT IS FORBIDDEN/TABOO

THE RULE THEIR ROMANCE BREAKS

Courtship & Marriage

Continue in Section 3

Courtship customs; Section 5 — Marriage laws

HOW PEOPLE COURT

WHAT TOUCH IS FORBIDDEN/SIGNIFICANT

WHAT MAKES MARRIAGE OFFICIAL

Language & Communication

Continue in Section 8

Language & Communication

LANGUAGES IN YOUR WORLD

COMMUNICATION BARRIER BETWEEN CHARACTERS

YOUR ANSWER

PRIVATE LANGUAGE OR SIGNALS THEY DEVELOP

YOUR ANSWER

RELIGION & BELIEF

Continue in Section 6

Religion, Myth & Prophecy

WHAT PEOPLE BELIEVE

YOUR ANSWER

RELIGIOUS OBSTACLE TO THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

SACRED VOWS THAT CONFLICT WITH LOVE

YOUR ANSWER

PROPHECY (IF ANY) AND HOW IT AFFECTS THE ROMANCE

YOUR ANSWER

Crisis of faith — what makes them question their beliefs?

CRISIS OF FAITH — WHAT MAKES THEM QUESTION THEIR BELIEFS?

LAWS THAT MATTER

Continue in Section 5

Government, Power & Law

LAW #1

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

LAW #2

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

LAW #3

PUNISHMENT FOR BREAKING

EFFECT ON ROMANCE

THE LAW THEY WILL BREAK

THE SPECIFIC CONSEQUENCES

THE ROMANCE MECHANICS

How They're Forced Together

Continue in Section 13

Pressure Cooker; Section 14 — Institutions

Primary mechanism:

☐

Fated mates/magical bond

☐

Arranged marriage/political alliance

☐

Academy/institutional partnership

☐

Dangerous mission/shared goal

☐

Geographical isolation

☐

Other: _____

DETAILS

YOUR ANSWER

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

At great cost

The “Why Now?”

Continue in Section 16

The “Why Now?” Test

What worldbuilding event kicks off their relationship?

WHAT WORLDBUILDING EVENT KICKS OFF THEIR RELATIONSHIP?

Why couldn't they have gotten together earlier?

WHY COULDN'T THEY HAVE GOTTEN TOGETHER EARLIER?

THE DEADLINE/TIME PRESSURE

WHAT HAPPENS IF THE DEADLINE PASSES

The Invisible Ledger

Continue in Section 4

Economy, Labour & Resources

Who starts with more economic/resource power? _____

The biggest entry on the ledger: (the debt, gift, or sacrifice neither can forget)

YOUR ANSWER

When does the ledger stop mattering? _____

How They're Kept Apart

Continue in Section 16

Romantasy-Specific Integration

OBSTACLE 1

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

OBSTACLE 2

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

OBSTACLE 3

WORLDBUILDING SOURCE

Power Dynamics

Continue in Section 18

Agency Check

WHO STARTS WITH MORE POWER

TYPE OF POWER

WHAT LEVERAGE THE WEAKER CHARACTER HOLDS

HOW POWER SHIFTS

PRESSURE POINTS

Location-Based

Continue in Section 15

Key Locations

WHERE THEY'RE TRAPPED TOGETHER

WHERE THEY MUST BE APART

WHERE DISCOVERY IS MOST DANGEROUS

Time-Based

Continue in Section 17

Dual Clock

THE DEADLINE

WHAT HAPPENS IF MISSED

Social-Based

WHO'S WATCHING

CONSEQUENCES OF BEING CAUGHT

CONFLICT ENGINES

External Conflict

THE MAIN THREAT/PROBLEM

YOUR ANSWER

WHY THEY MUST FACE IT TOGETHER

WHAT HAPPENS IF THEY FAIL

Internal Conflict

PROTAGONIST'S EMOTIONAL WOUND

HOW IT MAKES THEM RESIST THE RELATIONSHIP

LOVE INTEREST'S EMOTIONAL WOUND

HOW IT MAKES THEM RESIST

Where They Intersect

How external conflict forces them to face internal wounds:

HOW EXTERNAL CONFLICT FORCES THEM TO FACE INTERNAL WOUNDS:

How resolving relationship helps solve external problem:

HOW RESOLVING RELATIONSHIP HELPS SOLVE EXTERNAL PROBLEM:

KEY RULES (The 5-7 That Matter Most)

Continue in Section 17

Consistency Check

RULE #1

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #2

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #3

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #4

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE # 5

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE # 6

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

RULE #7

ROMANCE RELEVANCE

THE CHOICE MOMENTS

Continue in Section 18

Agency Check

When protagonist actively chooses love interest:

WHEN PROTAGONIST ACTIVELY CHOOSES LOVE INTEREST:

WHAT IT COSTS THEM

When love interest actively chooses protagonist:

WHEN LOVE INTEREST ACTIVELY CHOOSES PROTAGONIST:

WHAT IT COSTS THEM

The moment they defy worldbuilding rules to be together:

THE MOMENT THEY DEFY WORLDBUILDING RULES TO BE TOGETHER:

WHAT RULE THEY BREAK

THE CONSEQUENCES THEY ACCEPT

ROMANTIC TROPES IN USE

Check all that apply and note specifics:

- ☐ Forced Proximity — How: _____
- ☐ Forbidden Love — Why forbidden: _____
- ☐ Fated Mates — Type of bond: _____
- ☐ Enemies to Lovers — Why enemies: _____
- ☐ Power Imbalance — Who has power: _____
- ☐ Arranged Marriage — Why arranged: _____
- ☐ Only One Bed (or equivalent): _____
- ☐ Touch-Based Magic: _____
- ☐ Telepathic/Soul Bond: _____
- ☐ Protector Romance — Who protects whom: _____
- ☐ Grumpy/Sunshine — Who's which: _____
- ☐ Slow Burn — What prevents faster resolution: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

What makes your use of these tropes unique:

WHAT MAKES YOUR USE OF THESE TROPES UNIQUE:

THE CLIMAX

Continue in Section 16

Final Connection Check

External climax (fantasy plot resolution):

EXTERNAL CLIMAX (FANTASY PLOT RESOLUTION):

Relationship climax (romantic resolution):

RELATIONSHIP CLIMAX (ROMANTIC RESOLUTION):

How they happen together:

HOW THEY HAPPEN TOGETHER:

What they sacrifice:

PROTAGONIST

LOVE INTEREST

Why their union matters to the wider world:

WHY THEIR UNION MATTERS TO THE WIDER WORLD:

CONSISTENCY CHECKLIST

Continue in Section 17

Consistency Check

Before Writing a Scene:

- ☐ Travel time consistent with established distances?
- ☐ Magic limitations still apply?
- ☐ Authority figures present or absent for established reason?
- ☐ Established dangers still dangerous?
- ☐ Character knowledge accurate for this point in story?
- ☐ Political/social rules being enforced?
- ☐ Power levels consistent with previous scenes?

If Breaking a Rule:

- ☐ Is there an in-world explanation?
- ☐ Will there be consequences?
- ☐ Was this possibility set up earlier?

QUICK FACTS

CURRENCY

Timekeeping: (hours, days, calendar)

YOUR ANSWER

DISTANCE MEASUREMENTS

Major holidays/festivals:

Continue in Section 6

Sacred Time

YOUR ANSWER

COMMON PHRASES/SAYINGS

YOUR ANSWER

IMPORTANT SYMBOLS

WHAT PEOPLE SWEAR BY

TYPICAL FOOD/DRINK

CLIMATE/SEASONS

THE ELEVATOR PITCH

THE WORLD

THE CHARACTERS

THE CONFLICT

THE ROMANCE

THE STAKES

In one sentence:

IN ONE SENTENCE:

COMMON READER QUESTIONS

(Useful for marketing, queries, and pitch materials)

“What kind of magic system?”

"WHAT KIND OF MAGIC SYSTEM?"

“How is it different from [similar book]?”

"HOW IS IT DIFFERENT FROM [SIMILAR BOOK]?"

“Is it spicy or fade to black?” _____

“Major tropes?” _____

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

Yes

☐

No

☐

HFN (Happy For Now)

“Standalone or series?” _____

THINGS I'VE ESTABLISHED MID-DRAFT

(Add details here as you write so you don't forget them. Include page/chapter where established.)

YOUR ANSWER

NOTES TO SELF

(Reminders, inconsistencies caught, things to fix in revision)

YOUR ANSWER

THE INTEGRATION MANTRA

Continue in Section 16

Web of Systems

Every worldbuilding element should do at least two of these:

1. Push characters together OR pull them apart (ideally both)
2. Create opportunities for intimacy OR obstacles to overcome
3. Force meaningful choices with real costs
4. Have consistent rules the romance works within
5. Matter to both the fantasy plot AND the relationship

If an element doesn't do at least two of these, cut it or strengthen it.

FINAL CHECKLIST BEFORE DRAFTING

- ☐ World at-a-glance complete
- ☐ Character details consistent
- ☐ Timeline established
- ☐ Magic rules clear (including what magic can't do)
- ☐ Bond mechanics defined, if applicable (consent, rejection, limits)
- ☐ Key locations defined
- ☐ Religion/belief system sketched (if relevant to romance)
- ☐ "Why now?" catalyst identified
- ☐ Obstacles identified with worldbuilding sources
- ☐ Power dynamics mapped
- ☐ Economic ledger understood
- ☐ Choice moments identified
- ☐ Climax integrates romance and fantasy
- ☐ Consistency rules clear
- ☐ Integration Score completed (Section 16)

Ready to write.



Keep these sheets accessible. Update as your story evolves.

Happy writing!